

Italy- Final Itinerary with Booking Links

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Final Itinerary

Day and Date	Itinerary details
Monday, Dec 23	● Catch flight at 21:55 from Pune
Tuesday, Dec 24	● Arrive at Rome FCO Airport at 10:10 am ● Transfer to hotel, check in and relax Rome city sightseeing ● Colosseum, Roman Forum, Palantine Hill ○ option 1 - Guided Tour. A client has had personal experience with this tour company and had an excellent experience. 2:30 hrs in length. 1 pm tour on Dec 24 (Rs. 4721 pp), 9:30 am on Dec 25 (Rs. 5,666 pp) ○ option 2 - Guided Tour for colosseum only (includes tickets to Roman Forum and Palatine hill but the guided tour ends at the colosseum) 1 hr 15 mins, VIP entry, Rs. 5572 per person. 3 pm slot available on Dec 24, 1:30 pm slot on Dec 25 ○ option 3 - Not a Guided Tour. Skip the line tickets to all 3 places. Rs. 3,683 per person. 3 pm on Dec 24 ○ Our recommendation is to go with a guided tour, checking with the tour operator to make sure the colosseum is open on Dec 25, if they are then we would recommend going for the 9:30 am tour on Dec 25. If not, then would recommend option 2 at 3 pm on Dec 24 ● Pantheon ● Piazza Navona ● Special Christmas Eve Event, in the evening: You can visit St. Peters Square to view the large Vatican Christmas Tree (directly opposite the St. Peters Basilica) and plenty of lights, and you can also observe the Midnight Mass from a large screen at the square (at 10pm)

Wednesday, Dec 25	● Trevi Fountain ● Spanish steps? ● If you missed it on the previous day, visit the St. Peters Square during mid-day for a special free Christmas event, where the Pope will offer a Christmas blessing to everyone present ● Campo Fiori ● Our recommendation would be to have dinner in Trastevere- a district well known for its food scene and is very beautifully decorated at Christmas Time.
Thursday, Dec 26	● Day trip to Naples- 1.5 hr journey (leave before 11am- return by/after 7:30pm) Sightseeing in Naples - ● Galleria Umberto I, ● Castel Nuovo ● Napoli Sotterranea ○ <u>Guided Tour and Skip the line Entry:</u> Duration: 1.5 hrs. 12 pm, 2 pm, 4 pm, 6 pm slots available. Rs. 1383 pp (this guided tour costs the same amount of money as buying a ticket directly on the Napoli Sotterranea website which doesn't include a tour guide, so this is a better deal) ● L'Antica Pizzeria Da Michele ● The Mercatini di Natale e Presepi di Napoli (christmas market) ● Return back to Rome (1.5 hrs)

Friday, Dec 27	● Travel to Florence (1.5 hrs). Leave before 10 am Florence city sightseeing ● Piazza del Duomo- Admire the magnificent Duomo di Firenze, Giotto's Campanile and the Baptistery of St. John ● Climb the Duomo: For a breathtaking view of Florence, climb the dome of the Duomo. The climb is worth it! ○ The best (and the most cost effective) option is to purchase a Brunelleschi Pass which costs EUR 30 per person and gives access to all the monuments of Piazza del Duomo. The pass is valid for 3 days from the start date, however, the climb time must be selected while purchasing the pass. Do not be late by more than 5 mins to start your climb. The climb consists of 463 steps. The pass can be purchased from here. ● Visit the Accademia Gallery - Reserve tickets directly from the official b-ticket website. EUR 20 pp. Tickets available from 8:15 am to 5:30 pm. ● Visit the Museo Galileo - It takes about 1-2 hrs to explore this place. book directly from their website. EUR 14 pp. tickets available from 9:30 am to 4:30 pm at hourly intervals You can do any of the below in the evening- ● Stroll across the iconic Ponte Vecchio- a bridge lined with jewelry shops. ● Enjoy the picturesque views of the Arno River. ● Visit Piazza della Signoria- a bustling square filled with historical statues and buildings. ● Piazzale Michelangelo- Enjoy panoramic views of Florence from Piazzale Michelangelo. It's a perfect spot to watch the sunset. ● Explore the lively nightlife scene in Florence
Saturday, Dec 28	● Take a day trip to Pisa ● If you would like to visit Pisa only, then we recommend traveling on your own and buying tickets to the leaning tower of Pisa from the official website. This would be the most flexible as cost effective option as the tours are considerably more expensive. Round trip train tickets are ~ EUR 20 pp. The tickets to visit the Leaning Tower and the Cathedral only (Cathedral entry is free with any ticket) are EUR 20 pp. If you plan to visit the four additional sites (the Baptistery, the Camposanto, the Opera Museum and the Sinopie Museum) as well, the tickets are or EUR 27 pp. Total cost: EUR 40-47 pp.

	● Tours are recommended if you would like to spend the whole day (12-13) hrs. Tours generally depart at around 7:30 am, take you to Siena, San Gimignano and Pisa and serve lunch with wine at a winery. Tours that do not include entry tickets to the leaning tower of Pisa range from EUR 80 to EUR 113, example 1 and 2. Tours that do include entrance to the tower cost ~EUR 175, example.
Sunday, Dec 29	● Explore Florence at your own pace ● Go for a pizza/pasta making workshop ○ 3 types of Pasta + unlimited wine (3 hrs) - Rs. 6,176 pp ○ Pasta & Tiramisu (3 hrs) Cooking Class with Unlimited Wine - Rs. 5,991 pp
Monday, Dec 30	● Travel to Venice (2-2.5 hrs). Leave before 9am ● Venice city sightseeing ● St. Mark's Square: Start your day at the heart of Venice. Admire the stunning architecture of St. Mark's Basilica and Doge's Palace. Consider climbing the Campanile for panoramic city views. ● Gondola Ride: Experience the romance of Venice with a gondola ride through the canals. Enjoy the picturesque scenery and listen to the gondolier's songs. ● Rialto Bridge: Take a stroll over the iconic Rialto Bridge, one of the oldest bridges in Venice. Enjoy the bustling atmosphere and admire the shops and stalls. ● Explore the charming shops and boutiques in the city. Look for unique souvenirs, Venetian masks, and handcrafted jewelry.
Tuesday, Dec 31	● Travel to Milan (1.5 hrs). Leave by the 11:10 am train ● Duomo di Milano ● option 1 - Buy the entrance ticket directly from the website. Costs 10 EUR pp for entrance to the cathedral and you can add the climb to the terraces (by stairs) for another 14 EUR pp. if you wish to take the elevator, this would be an additional 16 EUR per person. Slots are available every half hour until 1:30pm. ● option 2 - This offers entrance to the cathedral and the terraces (Rs. 4794 pp if you choose access by stairs and Rs. 5,900 pp if you choose elevator. If you want to add an audio guide this will be Rs. 5622 pp with access by stairs and Rs. 6728 pp with access by elevator. Slots are available every half hour until 3pm.

	● option 3- most guided tours are either early in the morning or unavailable on this day. If you want one, this is the best option priced at Rs. 6132 pp and there is a slot at 4pm Note: there are 256 steps to access the terraces You can then choose to do any of the below: ● Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II: This stunning glass-roofed shopping arcade is a must-see. Enjoy a leisurely stroll and admire the beautiful architecture. ● La Scala: Take a guided tour of this world-renowned opera house and learn about its rich history. ● Castello Sforzesco: Explore this grand castle, which has served as a fortress, a palace, and a museum ● Parco Sempione: Relax in this beautiful park, perfect for a picnic or a leisurely stroll. ● Navigli District: Enjoy a romantic boat ride along the canals of this charming neighborhood.
Wednesday, Jan 1	● Catch Flight at 06:45 am from Milan ● Arrive in BOM at 22:30